

TEMPTATION

CRITIQUE

In this section, we put stuff through the grinder and closely examine what comes out; everything except gadgets, because there's more to life than just that

ANIME

Gakusen Toshi Asterisk

Clashing swords and flaming love

Animes always have a tint of their native culture embedded in their narrative, so does Gakusen Toshi Asterisk or popularly known as The Asterisk War. The Academy City on the Water or Asterisk is the world's largest stage for battle entertainment - The "Star Wars Festival." The entire storyline is woven around the super powered main protagonist Amagiri Ayato, a Star-pulse Generation who arrived at Asterisk at the invitation of the Student Council President of the, Seidoukan Academy. Unfortunately he was noticed by the 5th ranked Princess Julis-Alexia von Riessfelt, and



ended up having to duel her. The one thing that sets apart this anime from everything else is the brilliant depiction of sword play.

Rating: ★★★★★

– Ashish Panigrahi

MOVIE

Point Break

Not one of those worthy remakes

Remakes are rarely well made. Had we been completely oblivious to the existence of the original from the early 90's, we probably would not have had many complaints with Point Break, but this particular reboot kept us pining for Keanu Reeves and Patrick Swayze for two whole hours. Barring some adrenaline-fueled action sequences that seemed like they were straight out of a Red Bull documentary, Point Break had little to write home about.

The premise is the same as the original, of course – Johnny Utah (Luke Bracey) is a rookie FBI agent who's been tasked with busting a group of extreme sports junkies who're responsible for a series of well-coordinated and seemingly impossible robberies. The antagonist, a man who goes by the name of Bodhi (Edgar Ramirez), leads Utah to believe that what they're doing would assist them with being one with nature, and that they're essentially chasing nirvana. Unlike the original, the dynamics between Utah and Bodhi fail to be as convincing as they ought to have been, and Utah is more or less seamlessly woven into their Robin Hood-esque gang of bandits, without

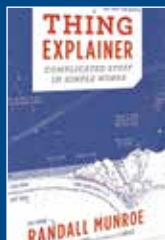


the slightest air of suspicion. Many of the supporting actors lacked background stories or definitive dialogues that could have potentially enriched the relevance of their roles.

The soundtrack wasn't all that bad – but it wasn't something that you'd expect from a movie based on a cult classic where you had tracks by Jimi Hendrix, and memorable rock bands like Ratt and Concrete Blonde. In short, if you're willing to periodically draw a blindfold over your eyes and restrict yourself to viewing the lens flare-ridden panoramic action sequences, you might find this highly unnecessary movie redeeming to a certain extent.

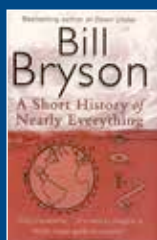
Rating: ★★★★★

– Shiv Issar



Thing Explainer

Certain science questions tend to bewilder us, and Munroe has the best way to explain them through simple drawings in his latest book. Consider this book as a "Explain Like I'm Five" for science.



A Short History of Nearly Everything

We've subscribed to Audible and our first recommendation would be this timeless piece from Bill Bryson. It covers topics right from the Big Bang to the rise of civilisation, with humour thrown in for free.



Elon Musk

This book throws light over real-life Tony Stark – Elon Musk's vision and how his entrepreneurial journey unfolded resulting into the formation of SpaceX, Tesla and SolarCity.